SACRUM / CORDATA

Finance Deck, Explained

A detailed guide to every slide, chart, formula, assumption and investor term

Use this to understand the story behind each number. The case history is supplied by the exercise; several splits, margins, contract details and forecasts are invented for practice.

Prepared for a soft-skills investor-pitch exercise

All financial figures are illustrative classroom assumptions, not verified company results.

How to use this guide

Read the deck left to right as one story: growth, better revenue quality, customer value, a driver-based plan, then the funding request. Use the glossary when a term feels unfamiliar. The numbers below reproduce the current build-deck.js model.

- A slide is a short argument supported by evidence. Explain what the visual shows, why it matters to the customer or investor, and what assumption sits behind it.
- Use CY for calendar year. H means a case-history year from the exercise; E means an estimate; A means an explicit assumption. These labels do not certify that any number is real.
- The model uses INR Cr for company revenue and INR lakh for smaller customer figures. INR 1 Cr = INR 100 lakh.
- A forecast is a set of assumptions linked by formulas. A formula can be arithmetically correct while its inputs remain uncertain.

The five-slide argument

Slide	Main question	Investor takeaway
1. Traction	Has the business found customers and grown?	The case grows from INR 0.44 Cr to INR 32 Cr recognized revenue and from 4 to 120 customers.
2. Revenue quality	Can software become a larger, higher-margin stream?	Cordata mix rises; recurring revenue and exit ARR must be distinguished from booked revenue.
3. Customer proof	Does the product produce measurable customer value?	The illustrative customer reports INR 32L annual savings against a INR 6L subscription.
4. Plan	How could the business reach the forecast?	Retention, expansion, new logos, PSU/international growth and hiring combine into the model.
5. Ask	Why raise, why now and what will the capital do?	INR 25 Cr funds product, sales, customer success and working capital over a planned 24 months.

Slide 1 — Growth and traction

The first slide establishes that Sacrum has a customer base and that revenue expanded over the historical case period. It should make the audience curious without implying that growth alone proves product-market fit.

Numbers in this slide

Calendar year	Services revenue	Cordata recognized revenue	Total recognized revenue	Customers	Employees
CY22H	INR 0.40 Cr	INR 0.04 Cr	INR 0.44 Cr	4	7
CY23H	INR 1.92 Cr	INR 0.48 Cr	INR 2.40 Cr	15	15
CY24H	INR 7.70 Cr	INR 3.30 Cr	INR 11.00 Cr	45	40
CY25H	INR 20.80 Cr	INR 11.20 Cr	INR 32.00 Cr	120	95

How to read the charts

- The stacked bar divides recognized revenue into Services and Cordata. The full height is the total. This is a good choice because both streams add to total revenue and their mix matters.
- The customer chart uses bars for customer count and a line for average revenue per customer. It has two vertical axes, so read each series from its own axis. A rising line suggests account size is increasing; it does not show that each customer is

growing.

- Revenue per customer is total recognized revenue divided by year-end customer count. It is a rough portfolio average, not a contract price or a cohort measure.

Derived headline figures

Measure	Calculation	Meaning / caution
73x revenue growth	INR 32 Cr ÷ INR 0.44 Cr ≈ 72.7x	Large multiple from a very small starting base; do not imply every year grew at this rate.
317% CAGR	(INR 32 Cr ÷ INR 0.44 Cr)^(1/3) − 1	Smoothed annual rate across three year-to-year intervals. The low base makes this unusually high.
Customer growth	120 ÷ 4 = 30x	The slide title uses 30x. Customer count is not the same as paying, active or recurring customers unless defined.
CY25 revenue per customer	INR 32 Cr × 100 ÷ 120 = INR 26.7L	Blended average; contract concentration can make the average misleading.
Total capital invested	INR 0.75 Cr angel + INR 0.18 Cr founders = INR 0.93 Cr	Use ‘capital invested’ for both sources; external money alone is INR 0.75 Cr.

Presenter explanation

“We entered through cloud services, then used those engagements to introduce Cordata. In the case history, revenue rises from INR 0.44 crore to INR 32 crore and the customer base grows from four to 120. The chart separates service revenue from platform revenue so you can see the mix shift as well as the growth.”

What could be challenged

- The CY22 total is INR 0.44 Cr, not INR 0.50 Cr, because the model has INR 0.40 Cr service revenue and INR 0.04 Cr recognized Cordata revenue. INR 0.10 Cr is exit ARR, a separate measure.
- Ask what counts as a customer: signed account, active paying logo, pilot, or any historical client. Define the rule and use it consistently.
- The 2024 and 2025 revenue split by stream is partly assumed in this training version. It is not independently verified by the story totals.

Slide 2 — Revenue quality and software mix

This slide argues that Cordata can make revenue more repeatable and improve gross margin. The key is to keep three different things separate: revenue recognized during the year, annual recurring revenue at year-end, and gross margin.

Recognized revenue versus exit ARR

Case year	Cordata recognized revenue	Cordata exit ARR	Why they differ
CY22H	INR 0.04 Cr (INR 4L)	INR 0.10 Cr (INR 10L)	The year-end subscription run rate can exceed the portion recognized during a partial year.
CY23H	INR 0.48 Cr	INR 0.80 Cr	Exit ARR is a case assumption, not calculated from revenue.
CY24H	INR 3.30 Cr	INR 5.00 Cr	Exit ARR is a case assumption.
CY25H	INR 11.20 Cr	INR 15.00 Cr	Recognized revenue is 35% of INR 32 Cr; exit ARR is a separate assumed run rate.

- Recognized revenue is the amount attributed to the accounting period as the service or software is delivered under the assumed contract terms.
- ARR is annualized recurring subscription value at a point in time. It is not the same as cash collected, total contract value, or recognized revenue.
- Do not add recognized Cordata revenue to exit ARR. They overlap in meaning and answer different questions.
- The chart of revenue mix uses one hundred percent stacked bars: the Cordata segment is 9%, 20%, 30% and 35% for CY22–CY25. The overlaid line shows blended gross margin on a second conceptually separate metric; label both clearly.

Gross margin calculation

Gross margin = (revenue − direct cost of delivering that revenue) ÷ revenue. In this model, services margins are assumed at 30%, 32%, 33%, and 35% for CY22–CY25; Cordata margins are assumed at 65%, 70%, 74%, and 78%. The blended margin weights each stream by its share of revenue.

CY25 example

Services gross profit = INR 20.8 Cr × 35% = INR 7.28 Cr. Cordata gross profit = INR 11.2 Cr × 78% = INR 8.736 Cr. Total gross profit = INR 16.016 Cr; blended gross margin = INR 16.016 Cr ÷ INR 32 Cr = 50.05%, rounded to 50%. This is an illustrative management allocation, not a verified accounting result.

- The chart shows estimated blended margin improving from about 33% to 50% in the history and to about 61% by CY28E, as assumed software share increases.
- A ten percentage-point mix shift toward Cordata at the CY25 margin assumptions adds about 4.3 percentage points of blended gross margin: 10% × (78% − 35%).
- Say what is included in direct costs. The deck note allocates delivery labor and pass-through cloud cost to services, and hosting, support and customer success to Cordata. Changing the allocation changes margin.

Investor takeaway

“We want Cordata to become a greater part of the business. Subscriptions can be repeatable, and the model assumes they have higher gross margin than services. The charts show the direction of travel; the margin assumptions still need evidence.”

Slide 3 — Customer value and efficiency

A named or anonymized customer example turns an abstract cloud platform into a clear customer result. It is persuasive only when the before-and-after period, measurement method and permission to share are credible.

Customer case arithmetic

Item	Amount	Interpretation
Consulting engagement	INR 12L	One-time year-one service fee in the example.
Cordata subscription	INR 6L per year	Recurring annual software fee.
Year-one spend	INR 18L	Consulting plus one annual subscription, assuming both are charged in year one.
Annual cloud savings	INR 32L	Customer benefit, assumed to continue for a full year.
Savings / recurring fee	INR 32L ÷ INR 6L = 5.3x	Savings-to-fee ratio. This is not conventional investment ROI.
Savings / first-year spend	INR 32L ÷ INR 18L = 1.8x	Annual savings-to-first-year-spend ratio.
Net savings after first-year spend	INR 32L − INR 18L = INR 14L	Assuming a full year of savings and no other costs.
Simple payback	INR 18L ÷ INR 32L × 12 ≈ 6.75 months	Assumes benefits accrue evenly from the start; actual timing can differ.

Important distinction: savings multiple and ROI

A 5.3x savings-to-subscription ratio means INR 5.33 of gross annual savings for every INR 1 of annual software fee. Conventional net ROI on the subscription alone would subtract the fee first: (INR 32L − INR 6L) ÷ INR 6L = 4.33x, or 433%. If you use the full year-one spend, net ROI is (INR 32L − INR 18L) ÷ INR 18L = 0.78x, or 78%. Use the simpler savings-to-fee wording on the slide so the audience does not mistake a ratio for profit return.

Other customer outcomes

The case also claims 18% lower cloud spend, 200+ idle resources removed and 75% less monthly reporting effort. The graphic should be read as evidence of operational value, but do not add the INR 32L savings a second time to the other outcomes; they may be different descriptions of the same project impact.

Presentation language

“The customer paid INR 6 lakh a year for Cordata and reports INR 32 lakh of annual cloud savings. That is a 5.3 times savings-to-fee ratio. Including the INR 12 lakh consulting engagement, first-year spend was INR 18 lakh; if the savings arrive evenly, that spend is recovered in about seven months.”

Slide 4 — Forecast, drivers and bridge

The forecast should explain the mechanics that get from the case-history revenue to the target. The waterfall bridge is useful because it shows positive and negative components, while the operating table makes the assumptions visible.

Core revenue bridge formula

Ending revenue = opening revenue − revenue churn + expansion revenue + new-logo contribution + PSU contribution + international contribution. Revenue churn and expansion are calculated against the opening revenue base for each year. The bridge sums the three years of contributions to move from CY25H to CY28E.

Year-by-year model

INR Cr	CY26E	CY27E	CY28E
Opening revenue	32.000	51.200	88.856
Revenue churn	(2.560)	(3.584)	(5.331)
Expansion	5.760	10.240	17.771
New enterprise logos	14.000	24.000	33.750
PSU revenue	2.000	5.000	8.000
International revenue	—	2.000	4.000
Ending revenue	51.200	88.856	147.046
Growth vs prior year	60%	74%	65%

CY26E worked example

Opening revenue is INR 32 Cr. Revenue churn is 8% × INR 32 Cr = INR 2.56 Cr lost. Expansion is 18% × INR 32 Cr = INR 5.76 Cr added. Forty new enterprise logos × INR 35L full-year revenue equivalent per logo ÷ 100 lakh per crore = INR 14 Cr. Add INR 2 Cr PSU revenue and no international revenue: INR 32 − INR 2.56 + INR 5.76 + INR 14 + INR 2 = INR 51.20 Cr.

New logo revenue assumption

The deck calls INR 35L, INR 40L and INR 45L an annual revenue equivalent per new logo. It adds the full equivalent to the year in which the logo is won. That simplifies timing: a mid-year contract might produce only part of a full year of recognized revenue. In a more careful model, forecast contract start month, implementation delays, services versus subscription, cancellations and revenue recognition separately.

Operating drivers and what they mean

Driver	CY26E	CY27E	CY28E	Model interpretation
Customers, year-end	154	210	283	Prior customers after logo churn plus new enterprise, PSU and international logos.
New enterprise logos	40	60	75	Won accounts added in each year.
Annual revenue equivalent per new logo	INR 35L	INR 40L	INR 45L	Full-year revenue contribution assumed for each logo.
Qualified opportunities	160	240	300	New logos ÷ 25% assumed win rate.
Quota-carrying reps	5	8	10	New logos ÷ 8 assumed wins per rep, rounded up.
Net revenue retention	110%	113%	114%	1 − revenue churn + existing-customer expansion.
Revenue per employee	INR 36L	INR 38L	INR 40L	Revenue divided by implied headcount; assumption drives hiring.
Headcount	142	234	368	Revenue ÷ revenue per employee, rounded.
Cordata revenue share	40%	48%	55%	Mix assumption applied to total forecast revenue.

Retention terms

- Revenue churn is the percentage of opening-period revenue lost from the existing customer base. It does not include new customers.
- Expansion is additional revenue from existing customers, such as more workloads, users, modules or consumption.
- Net revenue retention (NRR) = (opening recurring revenue − lost recurring revenue + expansion from the same cohort) ÷ opening recurring revenue. At 110%, the original cohort is 10% larger before adding new logos. The current simplified model uses all opening revenue as a proxy for the recurring base, so it is not a pure SaaS NRR calculation.
- Logo churn counts lost customer accounts; revenue churn weights the lost revenue. A small number of large customers can make the two rates very different.

Pipeline and sales capacity

At a 25% win rate, 160 qualified opportunities are needed to win 40 logos. At eight closed logos per quota-carrying representative, five reps are implied. These are planning assumptions, not proven historical productivity. The CY27 target new-business value is about INR 31 Cr; 3x qualified-pipeline coverage suggests a target pipeline near INR 93 Cr. A pipeline target is not the same thing as current qualified pipeline or a booking.

Bridge components over CY26E–CY28E

Bridge item	Three-year total contribution
CY25H starting revenue	INR 32.000 Cr
Revenue churn	−INR 11.475 Cr
Expansion	+INR 33.771 Cr
New enterprise revenue	+INR 71.750 Cr
PSU revenue	+INR 15.000 Cr
International revenue	+INR 6.000 Cr
CY28E ending revenue	INR 147.046 Cr

Reading the gross margin and EBITDA forecasts

Blended gross margin rises from about 50% in CY25H to 53%, 59% and 61% in CY26E–CY28E because the model assumes both higher product mix and improving stream margins. EBITDA is revenue after operating expenses but before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization. Forecast EBITDA margins are 9%, 1% and 8%, implying roughly INR 4.6 Cr, INR 0.9 Cr and INR 11.8 Cr EBITDA. The 1% CY27E margin is close to break-even and should be described as a thin cushion, not as strong profitability.

Risk of double counting

The revenue bridge's INR 2/5/8 Cr PSU line may already include the ONGC contract or other PSU work. If so, adding the ONGC annual value again would double count. Treat ONGC as a named example inside the PSU revenue line unless the model explicitly makes it incremental. The same check applies to international targets and new enterprise logos.

Slide 5 — Funding ask, use of funds and runway

The final slide answers why money is needed, what it buys, how long it supports the plan and why an investor might want to participate. A strong ask links each use of funds to a measurable milestone.

Use of funds

Category	Share	Amount	Example outcomes
Product engineering	40%	INR 10.0 Cr	AI recommendations, predictive governance and FinOps automation.
Sales expansion	30%	INR 7.5 Cr	Teams in Delhi, Bengaluru and Hyderabad; enterprise sales capacity.
Customer success	20%	INR 5.0 Cr	Implementation, support, adoption and retention.
Working capital	10%	INR 2.5 Cr	Bridge customer invoices and longer public-sector collection cycles.
Total	100%	INR 25.0 Cr	The four allocations sum to the requested amount.

Why raise while the model shows EBITDA profit?

The case says operating earnings are positive from CY24 onward, while the company wants to invest earlier in product, sales and customer success to pursue a larger market. A profitable company can raise to accelerate growth, protect working capital and build product capacity. The model's CY27E EBITDA margin falls to 1% during deployment, which signals the plan has little cushion if sales arrive late or costs run high.

Runway arithmetic

The planned 24-month deployment spends INR 25 Cr less the INR 2.5 Cr working-capital reserve, or INR 22.5 Cr. Dividing by 24 gives a simple planned investment rate of INR 0.9375 Cr per month. The model adds INR 2.5 Cr of assumed current cash: (INR 2.5 Cr current cash + INR 22.5 Cr deployable raise) ÷ INR 0.9375 Cr ≈ 26.7 months, rounded to about 27 months. This is a simplified runway calculation, not a full cash forecast. It ignores timing, taxes, capex, receivables beyond the reserve and possible changes in operating cash flow.

Working-capital check

The model assumes CY28E PSU revenue of INR 8 Cr and 110 days to collect. A simple receivables estimate is INR 8 Cr × 110 ÷ 365 = INR 2.41 Cr. That fits just inside the INR 2.5 Cr allocation, leaving only about INR 0.09 Cr of headroom before considering tax, vendor payment timing, seasonality, disputed invoices or growth in other receivables. In real cash planning, a monthly cash model is needed.

ONGC example: contract value is not annual revenue

Measure	Formula	Illustrative result
Total contract value (TCV)	Given for a three-year contract	INR 3.5 Cr
Annualized contract value	INR 3.5 Cr ÷ 3 years	INR 1.17 Cr / year
Recognized to date	INR 3.5 Cr × 15 elapsed months ÷ 36 months	INR 1.46 Cr
Remaining backlog	INR 3.5 Cr − INR 1.46 Cr	INR 2.04 Cr

This linear recognition calculation is an assumption. Real revenue recognition depends on contract milestones and accounting treatment. A multi-year contract's full TCV should not be presented as one year's revenue.

Potential investor benefit

An equity investor may benefit if Sacrum grows its recurring product revenue, margins and enterprise value; the potential return comes from the value of the ownership stake over time. No valuation, equity percentage, liquidation preference, exit timing or return guarantee is provided in this classroom model. The investor's expertise and introductions may also help the company build product, hire, enter enterprise accounts and manage longer sales cycles. Explain the potential upside while being clear that business and investment outcomes are uncertain.

Milestones that make the ask concrete

Connect the capital to measurable outcomes: release AI recommendations into beta, launch the three city sales teams, ship predictive governance and FinOps automation, convert pilots into paying recurring contracts, build a qualified pipeline, maintain support quality, and demonstrate cash collection performance. The 24-month timeline is only convincing if milestones, owners, hiring pace and spending are consistent with the forecast.

Charts used and why they work

Chart	What it shows	How to present it well
Stacked bars	Services and Cordata amounts that sum to revenue.	Keep the order and colors fixed; label units and call out actual/case-history versus estimates.
Bars + line	Customer count plus average revenue per customer.	Use a second axis only when labeled; explain that the average is not a cohort result.
100% stacked bars + margin line	Revenue mix and gross margin trend.	The line is a different metric; label it clearly and avoid implying mix equals margin.
Customer value bars	Customer spend compared with savings.	Use an explicit period for each bar; separate year-one spend, recurring fee and annual savings.
Waterfall / bridge	Opening revenue adjusted by churn, expansion and new contributions.	Ensure every step adds to the endpoint and avoid double counting contract revenue.
Horizontal use-of-funds bars	Amount assigned to each budget category.	Show both percentage and INR amount; confirm percentages total 100%.
Milestone timeline	What the raise funds over 24 months.	Tie milestones to outputs and dates, not only activity or hiring.

Glossary: finance and SaaS terms

Recognized revenue: Revenue attributed to the period in which contracted goods or services are delivered. It differs from cash collected and total contract value.

ARR (annual recurring revenue): Annualized recurring subscription run rate at a point in time. It is not a GAAP income-statement line and is not automatically recognized revenue.

Exit ARR: ARR at the end of the year. A company can end the year with INR 15 Cr ARR while recognizing a different amount during the year.

MRR: Monthly recurring revenue. ARR is often calculated as MRR × 12, when the revenue is genuinely recurring.

ACV (annual contract value): Annualized value of a contract, often excluding one-time implementation fees. Define whether it means signed value or recognized revenue contribution.

TCV (total contract value): Total value over the full contract term, including all committed years and sometimes one-time charges. It is not one year's revenue.

Bookings: Value of contracts signed during a period under a company's defined booking policy. It is not necessarily recognized revenue or cash.

Backlog: Contracted work not yet recognized as revenue, subject to cancellation and delivery terms. Here the estimated ONGC remainder is about INR 2.04 Cr.

Revenue mix: The share of total revenue from each stream. The Cordata mix is the share of recognized revenue attributed to the platform.

Gross profit: Revenue minus direct costs of delivering the service or product.

Gross margin: Gross profit divided by revenue, expressed as a percentage. Higher margin means more remains after direct delivery costs, before operating expenses.

Blended gross margin: Revenue-weighted average margin across Services and Cordata.

EBITDA: Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization. It is a proxy for operating performance, not cash flow or net profit.

EBITDA margin: EBITDA divided by revenue. A 1% margin means INR 0.01 of EBITDA per INR 1 of revenue.

CAGR: Compound annual growth rate: the smoothed rate that would move the starting value to the ending value over the stated number of intervals.

Logo / new logo: A customer company/account. A new logo is a newly won customer. Define whether pilots and non-paying accounts count.

Logo churn: Share of customer accounts lost in a period.

Revenue churn: Share of opening recurring or revenue base lost from existing customers. State which revenue base is used.

Expansion: Additional revenue from an existing customer through more usage, products, workloads or services.

NRR (net revenue retention): Revenue retained from the opening customer cohort after churn, contraction and expansion, divided by the opening cohort revenue. Above 100% means expansion outweighed losses.

GRR (gross revenue retention): Opening recurring revenue retained after churn and contraction, before expansion; cannot exceed 100%.

ARPC / ARPU: Average revenue per customer / user. Check that numerator and denominator refer to compatible time periods and populations.

Win rate: Share of qualified opportunities that become wins. The model assumes 25%. Define the opportunity stage and measurement window.

Pipeline coverage: Qualified pipeline divided by a target for bookings or new business. A 3x target does not mean a 3x probability of revenue.

Quota-carrying representative: Sales employee whose quota is to close a defined amount of business. Capacity should reflect ramp time and sales cycle.

CAC (customer acquisition cost): Sales and marketing cost required to acquire a new customer, divided by the number of new customers acquired over a period.

CAC payback: Time required for gross profit from a customer to recover the acquisition cost. Different from a customer's savings payback.

Revenue per employee: Revenue divided by headcount. It can be used to estimate staffing but should be checked against product mix and contractor use.

DSO (days sales outstanding): Average time to collect receivables. A 110-day assumption means cash may arrive well after revenue is recognized.

Working capital: Short-term cash needed to run operations, including receivables, payables and inventory. It can consume cash even when EBITDA is positive.

Runway: Approximate time cash lasts at an assumed net cash outflow rate. The deck's 27-month figure is simplified and includes assumed current cash.

Burn: Cash spent net of cash generated in a period. EBITDA is not the same as burn because working capital, capex, tax and financing also affect cash.

Capital invested: Money supplied to build the company. This model includes INR 0.75 Cr angel capital plus INR 0.18 Cr founder contributions.

Dilution: Reduction in an existing owner's percentage when new shares are issued. The deck does not specify valuation or ownership terms.

Pre-Series A: A fundraising stage before a later institutional Series A. Stage names are informal; investors will still examine traction, terms and milestones.

PSU: Public sector undertaking. A PSU customer may have procurement processes and collection cycles that differ from private customers.

DPIIT / GeM / CPPP: DPIIT is the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade. GeM and CPPP are public procurement routes; startup recognition does not guarantee a contract or waive every tender requirement.

Assumption and consistency checklist

- Use CY labels because this model assumes calendar years. H identifies the exercise's history and E the estimate. All numbers remain illustrative for this classroom activity.
- Keep CY22 revenue at INR 0.44 Cr if the model says INR 0.40 Cr services plus INR 0.04 Cr Cordata recognized revenue. Do not substitute INR 0.10 Cr exit ARR for recognized revenue.
- Treat INR 3.5 Cr ONGC as three-year TCV, not annual revenue. Keep it inside the PSU line unless clearly modeled separately.
- Use 110 days DSO if the INR 2.5 Cr working-capital provision is meant to cover the modelled INR 2.41 Cr receivables estimate. The cushion is small.
- Call the INR 3.0 Cr result cumulative EBITDA, not capital payback. EBITDA is not cash returned to investors.
- Use “savings-to-fee ratio” for 5.3x; conventional ROI subtracts the fee from the savings first.
- Treat the pipeline number as a target, not current CRM pipeline. Do not imply a shortlist, pilot, TCV or interest is recognized revenue.
- Explain that full-year revenue per new logo is applied in the year it is won. This is a classroom simplification and may overstate first-year recognized revenue if contracts close late.

Short version to remember

“The story is: services opened customer doors, Cordata is intended to scale recurring revenue and margin, a customer example shows value, the forecast is built from named drivers, and INR 25 Cr funds the next stage. The forecast is only as strong as its assumptions.”